

August 2026

Dear Satyanarayana,

I've worked in and around Walnut Creek long enough to recognize when a home has real substance, and 2037 Banbury Road caught my attention right away. A five-bedroom, single-story ranch on a 12,000-square-foot lot with mature redwoods and that kind of square footage is genuinely rare in this part of town. When I saw the listing come off the market at 59 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because I don't think the result reflects what the property is worth.

A home with this much going for it, at \$665 per square foot in a market where comparable updated ranches are regularly trading well above \$800, should not have struggled to find a buyer. My honest read is that the listing described the home accurately but never built the case for the price. The backyard with mature redwoods and the oversized single-story floor plan are exactly what a certain kind of Walnut Creek buyer is actively searching for, and the marketing needed to make those features feel like a destination, not a footnote.

I've put together a short analysis of what I think went wrong and how I'd approach this differently, and I've included it in this packet. It's specific to this property, not a generic overview, because I think the path forward here is pretty clear once you see where the buyer connection broke down.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside with my good wishes. If you're not, I'd genuinely welcome a conversation whenever the timing feels right for you. No pressure, just a straightforward talk about what I think this home can do.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

2037 Banbury Road

WALNUT CREEK, CA 94598

5.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,784 Sq Ft · WALNUT CREEK

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 2037 Banbury Road

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Rare Single-Story Ranch with Real Depth - and a Listing That Undersold It

2037 Banbury Road has the kind of profile that serious Walnut Creek buyers are actively hunting for. Five bedrooms on a single story is nearly impossible to find at this scale in the market. The 12,000-square-foot lot with mature redwoods, raised garden beds, and a private backyard creates an outdoor living environment that most homes in this price range simply cannot match. Add solar, updated hardwood flooring, a proper family room with a fireplace, and a location that puts downtown Walnut Creek, Heather Farm Park, and BART within easy reach, and this home checks nearly every box for the move-up buyer coming out of the East Bay or relocating from San Francisco.

A list price of \$1,849,999 translates to \$665 per square foot, which sits below the standard updated tier for Walnut Creek. That number should have made this home competitive. Instead, the listing ran 59 days and came off the market without a sale. The fundamentals and the outcome don't match, and that gap is almost always a strategy story, not a home story. The listing described features accurately but never gave buyers a reason to feel urgency, to understand what was distinctive here, or to see why the price was, if anything, a value relative to what they'd be getting.

\$1,849,999

List Price

\$665/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one thing above everything else: put the single-story footprint, the lot, and the outdoor environment front and center in a way that lets the right buyer picture their life here before they ever schedule a showing. That's not a cosmetic fix. It's a positioning and media decision, and it needs to be made before the home goes live again.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 59 Days and Counting, Buyer Psychology Has Shifted

At 59 days on the market, this listing crossed the threshold where buyer perception changes. Past the 45-day mark, the question in a buyer's mind stops being 'Is this a good home?' and becomes 'What's wrong with it?' That stigma wasn't created by anything the home did. It was created by a strategy that stayed on the same path long after the market had stopped responding. The right buyer for a five-bedroom single-story on a 12,000-square-foot lot in this neighborhood was out there during those 59 days. The listing just didn't find them. A relaunch needs a clean break from that history, not a re-entry that looks like more of the same.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses the Final Offer platform to create visible, structured buyer activity around a relaunch, so the market sees real demand in real time rather than a clock that's been running too long.

Friction #2: The Visual Assets Never Carried the Story Online

Mature redwoods, a private 12,000-square-foot lot, and a single-story ranch footprint are the kind of features that stop a buyer mid-scroll, but only if the photography treats them that way. A standard MLS package, front elevation and room-by-room interiors, leaves the backyard and the lot setting as an afterthought. For buyers shopping this price point from San Francisco or the inner East Bay, the outdoor environment and the sense of space are often the deciding factors. If those elements aren't front and center in the first four photos, qualified buyers move on before they ever register what the property is. This home had a visual story worth telling. The listing didn't tell it.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour puts the lot position, the mature tree canopy, and the private backyard in aerial context, giving online buyers the spatial sense of this property that ground photography simply cannot replicate.

Friction #3: \$665 Per Square Foot Is a Value, But the Listing Never Made That Case

At \$665 per square foot, this home came to market below the standard updated tier for Walnut Creek, which runs \$720 to \$800. That's a positioning advantage, but only if buyers understand what they're getting relative to that number. A five-bedroom single-story with solar, updated hardwood floors, a family room with a fireplace, and a 12,000-square-foot lot with mature redwoods has a clear value argument. That argument needs to be made explicitly, in the narrative, in the media, and in how the listing is framed against competing inventory. When buyers are comparing at this price point and don't see that story told clearly, they move on to the home where the case was made for them.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement puts an enhanced narrative directly on the listing page, so the value argument reaches buyers in the moment they're comparing options, not after they've already moved on.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	2037 Banbury Rd	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$665/sqft	Standard updated: \$720–\$800/sqft
Lot / Setting	12,000 sqft, mature redwoods, private backyard	Typical suburban lot, limited canopy or privacy
Architectural Character	Single-story Plambeck ranch, 1976, rare 5-bedroom footprint	Mix of two-story and split-level; true single-story uncommon at this size
Premium Features	Solar panels, updated hardwood floors, fireplace, oversized family room, laundry room	Standard builder finishes, fewer outdoor or energy features
HOA	None	None to minimal in most Walnut Creek neighborhoods

The verdict: At \$665/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$720-\$800/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$665 per square foot, 2037 Banbury Road came to market at the low end of the Walnut Creek standard updated range, which is a real competitive advantage that the listing strategy never capitalized on. The lot size, single-story footprint, and solar are all premium attributes in this market. A relaunch that leads with those specifics, backed by photography and placement that matches the quality of the home, has a clear path to attracting the buyer this property deserves.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Rebuild the Visual Presentation Around the Lot and Single-Story Scale

The outdoor environment and the rare five-bedroom single-story footprint are the two features that most directly justify renewed buyer interest at this price. Neither was presented in a way that let online buyers feel the scale of this property before scheduling a showing. A full media rebuild, including aerial coverage of the lot and mature tree canopy, cinematic backyard photography, and a 3D Matterport walk-through of the floor plan, would give buyers the spatial context they need to commit to a visit. First impressions in this market are made entirely online, and this home deserves a first impression that matches what it actually is.

Pillar II - Reframe the Narrative Around Value and Scarcity

At \$665 per square foot in a market where updated single-story ranches of this scale are rarely available, this home has a genuine value story to tell. The listing description was accurate but passive, a tour of features rather than an argument for why this specific combination matters. The relaunch narrative needs to name the scarcity directly: five bedrooms on a single level, no HOA, solar, a 12,000-square-foot private lot with mature redwoods, and a location that puts downtown Walnut Creek and BART within a short drive. That's not a checklist. That's a case. BrightWork writes listing copy the way a great buyer's agent would describe a home to a motivated client.

Pillar III - Reach the Buyer Who Hasn't Found This Home Yet

The buyer for a home like this often isn't browsing Walnut Creek specifically. They're a San Francisco or inner East Bay household that has decided to make a move and is doing early research online, looking for something that feels like a real upgrade in space, outdoor living, and ease of living. Passive MLS distribution doesn't find that person. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns put this home in front of buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda and the Diablo Valley before they've committed to a specific city or neighborhood, which is exactly the buyer pool this property was built for.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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